Sebastián Mancha, ✉: mancha@umd.edu, :https://smancha.github.io/ Updated: Aug 2026

Education

The University of Maryland, College Park 2022-2027 (expected)

- Ph.D. in Linguistics
  - Dissertation (tentative): "What'd you just say?: Sentence memory in production and comprehension"
  - Advisors: Dr. Ellen Lau and Dr. Colin Phillips

The University of Texas, Austin, TX 2018–2022

- B.A. in Linguistics, with departmental honors
  - **Thesis:** Clitic Production in Spanish-Portuguese Bilinguals
  - **Advisors:** Dr. John Beavers and Dr. Almeida Jacqueline Toribio
- B.A. in Iberian and Latin American Languages and Cultures (Spanish and Portuguese)

Research Interests

- General: Memory systems in psycho/neurolinguistics; computational models of memory; formal bases of linguistics
- Specific: Sentence recall, structural priming; episodic memory, serial order memory, chunking; Tree Adjoining Grammars, linguistic data structures

Publications

1. **Mancha, S.** & Lau, E. *In preparation.* "Noun memory drives sentence internal primacy and recency at clause boundaries".
2. Yu, X., **Mancha, S.**, Tian, X., Lau, E. 2026. "Shared neural computations for syntactic and morphological structures: evidence from Mandarin Chinese". *Cognitive Science.*
3. **Mancha, S**. 2021. "New Directions in Texan Spanish: From the Spanish in Texas to the Spanish of Texas ". *Mellon Mays Undergraduate Fellowship Journal.*

Conference Presentations

1. **Mancha, S**., Lau, E. "Verbs as privileged cues for sentence retrieval". Poster presented at Society for the Neurobiology of Language 17th Annual Meeting, 2025, Gallaudet University.
2. **Mancha, S**., Lau, E., Phillips, C. "Priming and Memory in the production of Spanish pronominal clitics". Poster presented at Human Sentence Processing, 2025, University of Maryland, College Park.
3. Shah, M., **Mancha, S**. "Affix-hopping without affixes hopping: Spanning eliminates the need for T-to-V lowering". Talk given at LSA Annual Conference, 2025, Philadelphia.
4. Dods, A., Türk, U., Macdonald, A., **Mancha, S**., Phillips, C., "Is the octopus regenerating? Comparing timing effects in sentence recall and picture description tasks". Poster presented at Human Sentence Processing, 2024, University of Michigan.

Teaching

- LING449A: Speaking and Memory; Sole instructor and course designer, University of Maryland, Fall 2025
- LING272: Biophysics of Language; Teaching Assistant for Dr. Juan Uriagereka, University of Maryland, Spring 2025
- LING 200: Introductory Linguistics; Teaching Assistant for Dr. Peggy Antonisse, University of Maryland, Spring 2024

Invited Talks

- "Clitics: Climbing, Priming, and Timing", Guest presentation in undergrad LING 440: Grammars and Cognition, University of Maryland, October 2023

Grants

- Language Science Center Student and Postdoc Mini-Grant
  - Project title: Specialized sentential structures in serial sentence recall?
  - Funding organization: Language Science Center (University of Maryland, College Park)
  - Amount: $1500
  - Period awarded: Oct 2025

Advising

- **Manasi Dixit**: Undergraduate, University of Maryland. Collaboration with Dr. Colin Phillips on an independent study examining memory for Hindi case marking

Honors and Fellowships

- NSF Graduate Research Fellowship Program 2022
- Kemp-Forman Memorial Endowed Presidential Scholarship 2021
- Stacie Maureen Sowell Endowed Presidential Scholarship 2021
- Mellon Mays Undergraduate Fellowship 2020

Service

- UMD Linguistics Department MayFest Committee, on language production, Fall 2025-Spring 2026
- UMD Linguistics Department Colloquium Committee, Fall 2024-Spring 2026
- UMD Linguistics Department Chair Search Committee, Graduate Student Representative, Spring 2024

Other education

Genetics & Neurobiology of Language Summer Course, Cold Spring Harbor Labs 2026

Neuromatch Academy, Computational Neuroscience 2023

North American Summer School for Logic, Language, and Information 2022

Technical Skills

- **Data analysis**:
  - Automated transcription pipelines for language production data, Event related potential/field analysis (E/MEG), Bayesian hierarchical modeling with brms
- **Software and Programming Languages**:
  - Python, R, PCIbex
- **Natural Languages**:
  - English (Native), Spanish (Heritage), Brazilian Portuguese (Advanced), Japanese (Intermediate)

References

Available on request